

Ombudsman: 58% ignored?

The Ombudsman's 2025 figures for environment and planning, recomputed from the report's tables

THE CLAIM

***“7 recommendations, or 58%,
were not implemented.”***

Office of the Ombudsman, Annual Report 2025, Commissioner for Environment and Planning

Newsbook, 2 July 2026: the highest rate of any commissioner; 22 reports escalated to Parliament.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Matches the tables;
small count.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

7 of 12

Sustained cases, 2025

Recommendation not implemented at closure (58%). Table 1.3.

42%

Still open when written

Five of 12 (partly implemented counted as implemented); two more were implemented after referral.

25–58%

Same office, 2023–25

46%, 25%, 58%. Eight to thirteen cases a year: it swings.

58 vs 53%

“Highest”

Education 53% of sustained cases; 67% if only cases with a recommendation count.

22

Reports to Parliament

Up from 14 (2023) and 16 (2024). Matches Table 1.22.

FAIR TO SAY

Not implementing a finding can be a legitimate disagreement; the report records what was not done, not why. The Commissioner's remit covers planning, building and transport licensing as well as the environment.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The list of the 12 sustained cases and their status.

☐ How the per-office counts in Tables 1.3 and 1.22 reconcile.

☐ The authorities' reasons for the five open cases.

☐ Case-level data for the Environment and Planning cases.